GETTING STARTED

Your first bout

1. Pick a champion. Set your water and blood markers to their starting values. Glory starts at 0
2. Assign your loadout: weapon in your right hand slot, shield or net in your left. Weapons and shields are free
3. Randomly pick the starting player — they get the first player marker. Place a marker on round 1
4. Each round: pay your armor upkeep, build a fresh 6-card hand, and play the six seconds (see EACH ROUND)
5. Each second: secretly pick a card, reveal together, act in player order, then burn (see EACH SECOND)

Example: I pick Vela, set my water to 20 and blood to 8, glory at 0. Gladius in my right hand, net in my left. We roll off — I get the marker. Round 1 begins

EACH ROUND

At the start of every round

1. Advance the round track
2. Shuffle your discard pile back into your deck
3. Choose 6 cards from your deck to build a fresh hand (planning)
4. Loadout upkeep: pay water equal to the water icons on your equipped gear, and gain glory equal to the glory stars. You may remove gear before paying
5. Play the six seconds: see EACH SECOND

Example: Round 3. I advance the tracker, shuffle my discards back in, pick 6 cards for my hand. My scutum and manica cost 3 water total — I pay it, gain 1 glory, and we're ready

EACH SECOND

CHOOSE → SHOW → ACT → BURN → REPEAT

1. CHOOSE — secretly pick a card from your hand, hold it in front of you and say "ready"
2. SHOW — all players reveal simultaneously, placing cards on the burn-down track at matching heat
3. ACT — in player order: take your card's actions (see Taking Actions)
4. BURN — slide all cards one slot right. Cards burning off score water and glory live
5. REPEAT — pass the first player marker right. Next second
6. If you hit zero water, see OUT OF WATER

TAKING ACTIONS

On your turn during ACT, in player order

1. All Move, Weapon, and Flourish cards in your track are active this second
2. You can skip any action you don't want to take
3. If you are at the edge, you can skip all your actions to either rally (get water) or change your loadout this second (not both)
4. Take your remaining actions in any order
5. If you attack, see Attack Resolution

Example: I've been lumbering for two seconds and riposting for one, now I'm also stabbing. I don't care to move because I'm in range of Cassius, so I'll attack him twice

ATTACK RESOLUTION

When an attack card resolves

1. Pair a weapon with the attack. You can use the same weapon with multiple attacks
2. Declare your target if multiple are in range
3. Defenders defend if they can, attackers apply any special weapon abilities
4. Successful attacks spill the defender's blood based on the weapon
5. Spilling 2 or more blood makes the defender prone
6. Prone defenders waste the next second getting up

Example: I'm stabbing Cassius with my sica, and also sottano-ing with my sica. Cassius defends with a parma, but I use my sica's ability to ignore his shield this second. Two attacks get through. Cassius loses two blood and is prone

GOING PRONE

Knocked down in the sand

1. Spilling 2 or more blood in one second makes the defender prone
2. A successful net attack makes the target prone (even with 0 blood)
3. Prone defenders waste the next second getting up
4. While prone, you cannot attack, defend, or move
5. Playing KIP-UP negates prone — snap back up immediately
6. After one full second prone, you stand back up and rejoin the fray

Example: Cassius hits me with his sica twice — 2 blood, I'm prone. I spend all of next second getting up while he circles. Then I'm back on my feet

OUT OF WATER

At zero water, you are crawling

1. All your remaining cards become "crawl" — move one hex per second toward the edge
2. No attacks, defends, or flourishes while crawling, but you still play a card each second
3. Attacking a crawling fighter costs 1 glory
4. Reach the edge: rally (get water) costs one second
5. Optionally change your loadout at the edge (costs one second)
6. Rejoin the fray — your cards are no longer crawl

Example: I'm out of water with three cards left. They all become crawl — I drag myself one hex per second toward the edge. I reach it, rally back 12 water, swap my scutum for a parma, and I'm back in the fight

BASIC RULES

Free movement — the simple intro version

1. Movement is free — no facing restrictions, move in any direction
2. No 60° turn limits. Turn as much as you like, whenever you like
3. Weapon arcs don't matter — if a target is in range, you can hit it
4. Shields block any attack from any direction
5. Wheel is just a flourish

Example: I'm facing Cassius but want to hit Drusa behind me. In basic rules I just turn and stab — no penalty, no facing to track

ADVANCED RULES

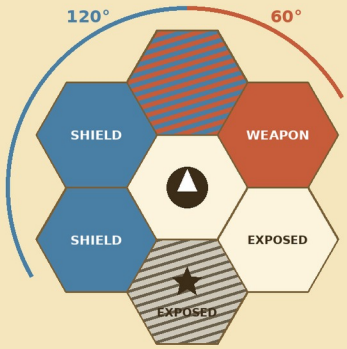
Facing, 60° turns, and weapon arcs

1. Facing matters — you have a front, sides, and back
2. You can change your facing 60° as a free action at any time during your action turn. The Wheel card turns you 120°
3. Weapons hit in their arc: 60° for most (forward + your weapon hand's side)
4. Shields block in their arc: Scutum 120°, Parma 60°
5. Back attacks cost glory. See the ARCS card for the visual

Example: I sidestep left and turn 60° to face Cassius, keeping my scutum toward him. My gladius covers my front and right — Drusa on my left is safe this second

WEAPON & SHIELD ARCS

Example: shield in left hand, weapon in right hand



- A weapon hits the forward hex and the hex on its hand's side (60° arc)
- A shield covers the two hexes on its hand's side (120° arc)

The rear is always exposed. Back attacks cost glory

Mirror the arcs if your loadout swaps hands

